

am not going to sit around a dock with a bunch of 20-year-old bimbos primping and pouting in their bikinis. Larry and I will not be attending unless all those girls are gone.”

Everyone went silent. Then Linda leaned over and whispered to me, “It’s about time.”

This declaration became known among our friends as the Denise Decree. The Denise Decree resonated through our group like a lightning bolt. And Denise was such a respected and well-liked matriarch that her decree was actually adopted as a rule for the dock party: no young bimbo girlfriends allowed.

One longtime male attendee who’d divorced one of Denise’s friends actually asked her for special permission—“Can’t I get grandfathered in? I’ve been with my 28-year-old girlfriend for three years!” The answer was no. The Denise Decree was law. No exceptions.

Both Linda and I supported Denise 100 percent. Here was a woman who had worked tirelessly to create a family dynasty. She had made endless sacrifices, raising three great kids while Larry was off working to build the family fortune. She’d supported many business pursuits, and she’d always gone the extra mile to make the dock party great, even though she wasn’t the hostess. Denise was a role model for all of us, and especially for all the women her age who’d protected, raised and managed stable families for decades.

I talk at length about gold diggers in my second book, but suffice to say that most of those young ladies are after one thing and one thing only: a middle-aged man’s wallet. I know one story of a young gold digger who regularly costs her middle-aged man \$50,000 per weekend in shopping trips. Not only is that financial suicide, it’s also cheating his wife and family of what should be their legacy, their dynasty.

Ladies: if your man is going through a midlife crisis that affects not only your relationship but your bank book, make sure you protect yourself. The Denise Decree should be your inspiration. Either your husband reconfirms his stake in your relationship and in building the dynasty, or he’s out. And if leaving is the only option,